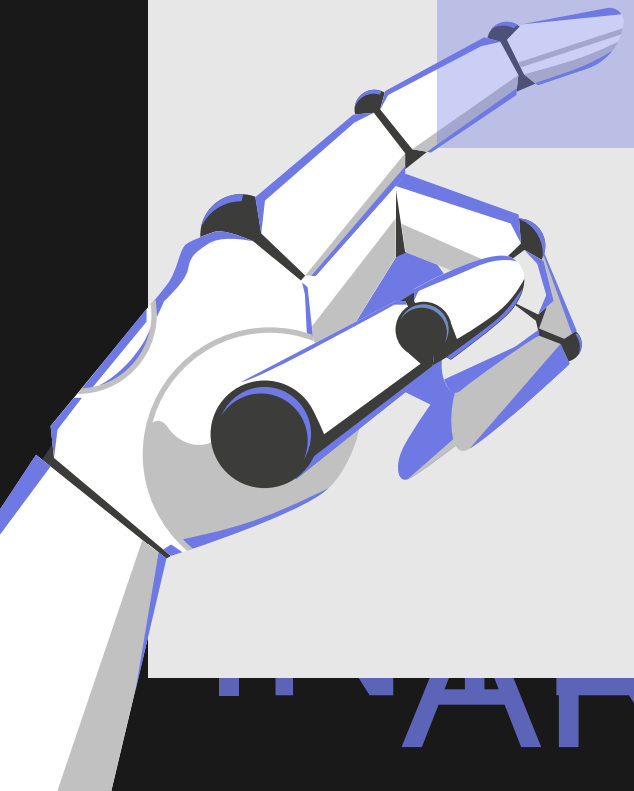
AI Timeline



A structured history from Dartmouth to large-scale models

Origins of AI

AI began as an explicit research program in 1956 at the Dartmouth Workshop. Early optimism in the 1950s–60s spurred foundational work in logic, search, and early neural models, but also fueled unrealistically high expectations. Since then, progress has unfolded as alternating bursts of ambitious goals and pragmatic consolidation, shaping the timeline we study today.

Turning Points

This slide asks how breakthroughs, resources, and institutional shifts jointly shape AI milestones. Our lens treats milestones as interactions among four axes: algorithmic innovation, dataset scale, compute/hardware, and funding/commercialization. Milestones are categorized along these axes to clarify the forces at work.



Timeline Process

01

Identify Milestones

Compile canonical milestones with key dates and events (Dartmouth 1956; Rosenblatt 1958 perceptron; Minsky & Papert critique 1969; backprop resurgence 1986; ImageNet/AlexNe

02

Collect Indicators

Gather quantitative signals: dataset sizes, model parameter counts, benchmark error rates.

03

Validate Sources

Cross-check dates and claims against primary sources such as conference papers and release notes.

04

Map Impacts

Link milestones to shifts in research agendas and industry adoption.

Early Wins, Then Winter

1950s–1960s featured symbolic systems and early neural ideas. Perceptron experiments demonstrated pattern recognition potential, while logic-based AI explored structured problem solving.

Minsky & Papert (1969) exposed fundamental limits of perceptrons. Government reviews and cautious funding cuts slowed progress on large-scale AI projects in the early 1970s.

Unmet expectations and funding contractions sparked the first AI winter (mid-1970s to 1980).

Scale Drives Gains

Dataset size and model capacity surged since 2012, driving reproducible gains on core benchmarks.

1.2M

ImageNet: labeled images used by AlexNet (2012) to catalyze vision progress.

~25% → ~15

ImageNet top-5 error with early models after AlexNet (2012) drop.

175B

GPT-3 (2020) milestone in parameter scale; orders of magnitude larger than early nets.

Cloud-Scale Reality

Public cloud market	On-demand GPU/TPU access enabled rapid experimentation.	$1B
Compute concentration	Modern models demand hundreds to thousands of GPUs/TPUs.	1000x

Alignment Ahead

AI progress compounds when algorithms, data, and infrastructure advance together. Policy and governance must address concentrated compute and data resources that shape access and impact. Open questions include reproducible evaluation for very large systems, equitable compute access, and robust alignment and safety. The timeline focuses on milestones and metrics, while social, ethical, and geopolit

THANKS

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